

Newsletter No 10

**ROSSHOLME
KENYA**

March 2023

We have had an interesting few months since our last Newsletter and some exciting developments to report.

The new term started in January with 40 new beginners bringing our total school population to 411; who would have thought we would reach this number in seven years? In November, the fifteen Grade 6 pupils did their National exams; they all did really well, achieving excellent results but had to move on to Junior High School. These included six of our original starter pupils from 2016 and we were very keen that, after such a good educational start, they should remain in school. As our Headteacher, Joyce, commented

"At least they are now big enough to walk some kilometres to join government junior high schools because there are none within Kiambiu"

Our financial emphasis has to remain with Rossholme and the provision that we support but we are still researching ways of accessing financial support for these children, remembering that even Government schools are neither compulsory nor completely free.

The provision of computers last year has been a huge success and made a great difference to the learning we are able to provide at Rossholme... now we need more! Some of our recent pictures show the installation of solar power which means our classrooms have electric lighting. "We were previously dependent on illegal electricity connections which was very costly since they charge without meter readings"

This has been possible thanks to the generous donations from East Africa Children's Project (EACP). A chance encounter by Libby Tidswell, one of our very loyal supporters, with Pieter Lagaay, Chairman of EACP has been very worthwhile. Meticulous investigation by EACP to ensure that RinK was completely 'above board', was concluded when they invited Joyce to join a Zoom call with their Secretary and Treasurer; they were certainly charmed and reassured of her integrity! Her super-efficient organisation of the solar panel installation – all done within a week - means they are now planning to support another project. Joyce is requesting funds for new desks and lockers throughout the school because present ones have all been 'acquired' from various sources and are in serious need of renewal. Pieter and some of his trustees plan to visit Rossholme in June this year and long term support from EACP will make a significant difference to our ongoing plans.

Through Pieter, we are also hopeful of establishing a 'twinning/link' with St James' Preparatory School in London and initial contacts with the Head have already been made.

STOP PRESS • STOP PRESS • STOP PRESS



Just look at these new desks – and thank you to EACP!



Installing solar power giving classrooms electric lighting.



Search for Nairobi/Kenyan based trustee



Looking ahead to the proposed development of Rossholme within the Kiambiu Slum, we are very keen to find a new trustee who is based in Kenya and understands the local economy and business. We have tried several contacts but, thus far, without success. Megan Wright and the TUSHINDE charity continue to provide financial support as well as local help and advice because they have a Kiambiu office and staff on the ground but we would still like to spread our network and local links within Kenya and Nairobi in particular.



**ROSSHOLME
KENYA**

WHAT'S THAT ABOUT?

Registered as a Charitable Incorporated Organisation (CIO), Charity No 1178553

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For further info please contact Judy Webb
judy@rossholmeinkenya.org

FUNDRAISING

We are a registered charity (number 1178553) which means that Gift Aid can be claimed on donations made by UK tax payers. Donations can now be made through CAFDonate which can be accessed through our website:
www.rossholmeinkenya.org

CAFDonate will also process the GiftAid or, alternatively, if donations are made directly to the charity, a GiftAid form can be downloaded from the website and returned to: judy@rossholmeinkenya.org 25% Gift Aid makes a significant difference to the donations you are kind enough to make. Unfortunately, Amazon Smile have now discontinued their donations on every purchase made.

We aim to publish a Newsletter about every 6 months so, if you know of anyone else who may be interested in receiving one by email, please let us know. In line with GDPR, we need permission for names to be on a mailing list but we assure you that it is not published anywhere; it is retained only by us and all emails are BCC'd so no list of emails is available.



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In April last year, the 'Having a Larf' show, led by Steve Swan, Chris Britton and Phil Moore was held here in Appley Pavilion and raised well over £2000 for Rossholme. It comprised some wonderfully funny skits and playlets and Steve Swan is now putting together a humorous book, 'What's That About?' which will include a combination of extracts from these sketches and other musings Steve has been writing. When published, copies will be available for a donation of £10 minimum for Rossholme. Steve and his family are very loyal supporters of Rossholme and we are very grateful to him for the ongoing contributions he makes to Rossholme. Look out for further details of this exciting project ...

Dear Rossholme Trustees

Receive our greetings. As Rossholme community, we're so grateful to you all. All our students are back to school very safe and sound.

We began the new school term on 23rd January. We added 40 new beginners who are aged between 3-4 years. We're now having a total population of 411 students. Friends we're very much grateful for your love and support. We've come this far because of your support.

We **received computers** and our computer classes are going on smoothly. We are also thankful that, through Judy, we got a friend, **Pieter**, who has helped us install solar lights in school. We're free from illegal electricity connections which was very costly since they charge without meter readings. We **expanded the school compound** last year from the adjacent plot to accommodate

Money, money, money!

Significantly increased numbers of pupils at Rossholme mean a significant increase in staff numbers and costs. We now send out £1000 per month to pay rent and staff salaries so this is what we need to raise each month. We appreciate enormously the regular payments we receive from our loyal supporters and, as you know, every penny goes out to Kenya to support the school; there are no administrative charges at all. By maintaining our Lloyds account as a school account, we do not have to pay charges on it and, by sending money out to Kenya using M-PESA and SendWave, we don't have to pay charges on that either. We now earn a small amount of interest on our CAF account which just covers those bank charges and we claim Gift Aid (an additional 25% on donations given by UK Taxpayers) wherever we can. If anyone feels able to donate a little extra, they can be assured that, unlike many of the large, national charities, every penny goes where it is needed!



the increased number of the learners in the school.

We are also **thankful that our US friends** will still support the feeding program for the whole of this year.

Our **grade six did their national exams** last year in November. We are so pleased that they did so well and **posted good results!** Since we don't have junior high school, we had to release them to join junior high school in other schools. Please, we request you that you **continue supporting us so that we may acquire our own land** because the landlord keeps on increasing rent on a yearly basis which is becoming too costly for us.

Once again, thank you very very much. We're indebted for your love.

Peace and love,

Joyce, teachers and Rossholme children.

Judy plans to visit Rossholme in early June and hopes to meet people in Nairobi who will be able to help with the future development of the school.

